

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, STATE OF FLORIDA**

SARAH S. HANSON,
Petitioner,

CASE No. 24-DR-001150
DIV. A

and
CHRISTOPHER A. HANSON,
Respondent.

_____ /

AMENDED ORDER APPOINTING GUARDIAN *AD LITEM*

THIS COURT, finds it to be in the best interest of the parties' minor child(ren), H.H.G., and H.H.G., to appoint a Guardian *ad Litem* on behalf of the minor child(ren). Therefore, it is **ORDERED:**

1. The Court hereby appoints ALEXA A. RODRIGUEZ, ESQ., whose professional address is AAR Family Law, PLLC 4830 W. Kennedy Blvd. Suite 600 Tampa, Florida 33609, and whose email address is alexa@aarfamilylaw.com as the Guardian *ad Litem* to act as next friend of the minor child(ren) and to investigate, evaluate, make recommendations to the Court, and to otherwise advance the best interest of the parties' minor child(ren) to the fullest extent allowed by Florida law:

2. The Guardian *ad Litem* shall have the powers, privileges, and responsibilities authorized in §61.403, Fla. Stat. and as provided in this Order, to the extent necessary to advance the best interests of the child(ren).

3. The Guardian *ad Litem* shall inquire, evaluate, and investigate the circumstances and facts relevant to the parties and the minor child(ren), any allegations of the parties or the minor child(ren), or of other persons or agencies relevant to the best interests of the minor child(ren).

The Guardian *ad Litem* shall interview the parties and the minor child(ren) in this case, as well as any third persons and entities in the sole discretion of the Guardian *ad Litem*. For example, it is common for the Guardian to interview other persons who have information pertinent to the parents or the child(ren) including counselors, household members, teachers, medical providers, family members, friends of the child or the parents, law enforcement officers, parenting coordinators, witnesses, investigators, parent employers, and/or any other persons having information concerning the best interests or welfare of the minor child(ren). The parties specifically waive the notice requirements as set forth in section 61.403(1), Fla. Stat., to the fullest extent allowed by law.

4. The parties shall each provide a list of collateral witnesses that they wish for the Guardian *ad Litem* to interview. Prior to providing that list to the Guardian *ad Litem*, each party shall ensure that each witness is willing and available to be interviewed by the Guardian *ad Litem* within the next three weeks. Each party's proposed collateral witness list shall include contact information for each witness (i.e. telephone numbers and email addresses) and a detailed summary of the relevant information that party believes the witness will provide to the Guardian *ad Litem*. Thereafter, the Guardian *ad Litem* shall choose which of those individuals to contact and interview at her sole discretion.

5. The parties or any other person entrusted by the parties with the care of the minor child(ren) shall permit the Guardian *ad Litem* to have access to the minor child(ren) as requested by the Guardian *ad Litem*. No person shall interfere with the Guardian *ad Litem*'s access to the minor child(ren). The parents shall also allow the Guardian *ad Litem* access to locations where the minor child(ren) do or may spend time, regardless of the presence of the minor child(ren) at the time. For example, the Guardian *ad Litem* may present herself at the school, activity location, or a

home of the minor child(ren) at a time when the minor child(ren) are not present or without advance coordination. No person shall interfere with such access.

6. The Guardian *ad Litem* shall be provided with copies of all pleadings, notices, and other documents filed in this action. The Guardian *ad Litem* may request Court scheduling, file pleadings, motions, or requests for relief as allowed by law, and as the Guardian *ad Litem* deems appropriate or necessary and may request discovery. The Guardian *ad Litem* is entitled to be present and to participate in all depositions, hearings, and other proceedings in the action, and may compel the attendance of witnesses. As such, all hearings, depositions or other proceedings in this matter shall be coordinated with the Guardian *ad Litem* so that she has an opportunity to attend. As this Guardian *ad Litem* is a licensed attorney in good standing with the Florida Bar, the parties waive any requirement that the Guardian *ad Litem* must question witnesses, conduct discovery, or otherwise address the Court through a separate attorney representing the Guardian *ad Litem*. The Guardian *ad Litem* shall be noticed of any mediation set.

7. The parties shall utilize the Our Family Wizard ("OFW") platform for all communications concerning the minor child(ren). Except in the event of an emergency involving an immediate threat to the health, safety, or welfare of the minor child(ren), all communications regarding the minor child(ren) shall occur exclusively through OFW. Each party shall maintain an active OFW subscription at his or her own expense, shall check OFW at least once daily, and shall respond to communications within twenty-four (24) hours. Communications through OFW shall be authored and sent only by the parties and not by any third party on a party's behalf. Both parties shall grant professional access to the Guardian *ad Litem* through OFW, allowing the Guardian *ad Litem* to review communications, calendar entries, and records maintained therein. The parties shall utilize the OFW calendar to record all appointments, activities, and events

concerning the minor child(ren), including medical, dental, educational, extracurricular, and counseling matters, and shall promptly update any scheduling changes. In the event emergency communication occurs by telephone, text message, email, or other means, the communicating party shall document the substance of the communication on OFW as soon as practicable, but no later than twenty-four (24) hours thereafter, unless impracticable.

8. The Guardian *ad Litem* may address the Court at any time regarding concerns or issues pertaining to the parents and/or the minor child(ren) in this matter. The Guardian *ad Litem* may make written and oral recommendations and a statement of the wishes of the minor child(ren) to the Court. The Guardian *ad Litem* is entitled to reasonable notice before any actions affecting the minor child(ren) are taken by either of the parties, counsel, or the Court.

9. The Guardian *ad Litem* is hereby authorized to obtain any confidential records, documents, notes, or other materials by presenting a copy of this Order to the record custodians of any agency, office or entity. No person or agency shall interfere with the Guardian *ad Litem's* access to confidential records or documents of the minor child(ren) or the parents involved in this matter without further release or order of Court. Both parents shall expeditiously execute all documents necessary for the Guardian *ad Litem* to obtain any confidential records, documents, notes, and the parties shall bear the costs of obtaining said records at 50% Mother / 50% Father, in no event will the Guardian *ad Litem* be responsible for said costs.

10. Upon presentation of a copy of this Order to any agency, or organization, including, but not limited to, schools, hospitals, the Clerk of any court of this state, the Department of Children and Families, human service agencies, human resource offices, and/or child-caring agencies, medical and mental health professionals, (including doctors, nurses, pediatricians, psychologist, psychiatrists, counselors and staff), and law enforcement agencies,

the Guardian *ad Litem* is hereby authorized to inspect and copy any records relating to the above-named minor child(ren) and parents (parties), including any forensic interviews conducted of the above-named minor child(ren) by the Department of Children and Families or law enforcement agencies without consent of the minor child(ren), the minor child(ren)'s parents, or any other person or entity. Said persons, agencies, or organization(s) shall not interfere with the Guardian *ad Litem*'s access to the minor child(ren). This Order further directs any agency or organization presented with this Order to comply with same. No person or agency shall interfere with the Guardian *ad Litem*'s access to confidential records or documents of the minor child(ren), or the parents involved in this matter.

11. The Guardian *ad Litem* may petition the Court, if necessary, for an order directed to a specific person, agency, or organization, including, but not limited to, schools, hospitals, medical doctors, dentists, psychologists, and psychiatrists, which order directs that the Guardian *ad Litem* be allowed to inspect and copy any records and documents which relate to the minor child(ren) or to the minor child(ren)'s parents or household members with whom the minor child(ren) reside. Such an order for release of records shall be obtained only after notice to all parties and without the necessity of a hearing on the Guardian *ad Litem*'s request for records, unless either party objects in writing to same. The parties and the Guardian *ad Litem* agree such request and written objection(s) may be resolved by the Court without hearing.

12. The Guardian *ad Litem* shall maintain as confidential all information and documents received from any source under this paragraph and may not disclose such information or documents except, in the Guardian *ad Litem*'s sole discretion, in a report served upon both parties and their counsel, or as directed by the Court. Neither party shall have the ability to obtain in any manner the Guardian *ad Litem*'s notes, file, or other file/investigative materials, as all such

materials are privileged, confidential, and are not discoverable by either party for any reason.

13. The Guardian *ad Litem* may prepare and file with the Court a written report which addresses some or all of the Guardian *ad Litem*'s investigations, findings, and/or recommendations on some or all issues, temporary, at any time, but not less than 20 days prior to any non-emergency hearing regarding timesharing or parental responsibility or a final hearing, unless counsel for the parties or the Court waives such time limit. Additionally, the parties may waive the requirement of a report prior to any hearing, in which case the Guardian *ad Litem* may orally inform the parties and counsel of her findings and recommendations either via telephone, in person discussion, via Zoom conference, or at hearing or case management/status conference.

14. The Guardian *ad Litem* may testify before the Court and the technical rules of evidence do not exclude the Guardian *ad Litem*'s reports, recommendations (interim, partial, temporary, final, formal, or informal) or the Guardian's testimony from consideration by the Court, including waiver of hearsay and authentication. Further, the parties expressly waive all hearsay rules and/or hearsay objections to statements, documents, reports, recommendations, or other information from the child(ren), from third parties, from experts/professionals, and/or from any other person or entity in Guardian *ad Litem*'s testimony, statements, reports, and recommendations of including hearsay within hearsay. The Guardian *ad Litem* may advise the Court orally or in writing as to statements and/or information obtained from any source in the Guardian *ad Litem* sole discretion.

15. The Guardian *ad Litem* may address the Court and make written and oral recommendations and a statement of the wishes of the child(ren) (when appropriate) to the Court. The Guardian *ad Litem* must be provided with copies of all pleadings, notices and other documents

filed in the action and is entitled to reasonable notice before any action affecting the child(ren) is taken by either of the parties, their counsel, or the Court.

16. A retainer fee shall be paid to the Guardian *ad Litem* in the amount of six thousand dollars (\$6,000.00) within 3 days of entry of this Order, of which Mother shall pay 50% and Father shall pay 50%, subject to later reallocation upon written agreement or court order. The Guardian *ad Litem*'s hourly rate is \$325.00 per hour. To expedite work and/or to reduce costs, the Guardian may utilize staff, including paralegals. Paralegal work is to be paid at the hourly rate of \$100.00. Mother and Father shall be responsible for payment to the Guardian at the rate of 50% Mother and 50% Father, subject to later reallocation upon written agreement or court order for: a.) All hours of work performed by the Guardian and paralegal(s), if any; b.) all case-related costs incurred by the Guardian; and c.) all additional retainers requested by the Guardian. All bills and retainer requests from the Guardian shall be paid within 10 days of the parties' receipt of the same. Procedurally, the retainer shall be kept in the Guardian's trust account, and the parties shall pay the bi-weekly invoice within 10 days of receipt. Should the invoice not be paid, the retainer funds may be applied, and the parties shall replenish the retainer upon request. Should the parties fail to pay the Guardian *ad Litem*'s initial retainer, subsequent retainers, and/or invoices for services and expenses, the parties understand that the Guardian may but is not required to, cease investigations and other work in their case until all bills, invoices and/or retainers are paid in full. All bills and retainer requests from the Guardian shall be paid within 10 days of the parties' receipt of same. If the Guardian's fees are not paid within 15 days of presentment of a bill or invoice, the Guardian shall be permitted to file a notice with the court, verified, setting forth the unpaid balance and the Court may enter an order *ex parte* regarding payment, stay, discharge, or order to show cause, or set a hearing on an expedited basis. The Guardian is entitled to be paid in full prior to the providing

and/or filing of any Report and Recommendations. In the event the Guardian is not paid in full, the Report and Recommendations is not required to be provided or filed until satisfactory arrangements have been made for payment.

17. The Guardian *Ad Litem* is appointed to assist and advise the Court in advancing the best interest of the minor child(ren) to the broadest extent such best interest standard may be interpreted and applied. The Guardian *Ad Litem* is not required to act as counsel for herself or to defend any legal positions of the Guardian in any hearings, depositions, motions, or other proceedings. As such, the Guardian shall be entitled to obtain legal counsel of her choice relating to the Guardian's involvement in this matter in any hearings, depositions, motions, or other proceedings. The cost of which shall be paid by the parties 50% Mother/50% Father upon request of the Guardian prior to the event occurring. Should the parties fail to make timely payment of the Guardian's reasonable attorney fees upon request, the Guardian shall not be required to attend the event.

18. The Guardian *ad Litem* is hereby relieved of and shall be immune from any liability for any action performed in the furtherance of her responsibilities and duties as set forth herein. Each party hereby waives any and all claims they may have or shall have in the future with regard to any actions, recommendations, testimony, or conduct of by the Guardian *ad Litem*, whether now and in the future. The immunity provided by section 61.405, Fla. Stat., shall not be exclusive but in addition to all other afforded to a court appointed Guardian *ad Litem*.

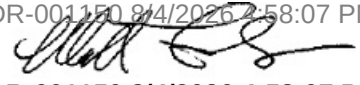
19. The parents acknowledge that they are prohibited from posting any online reviews concerning the Guardian *ad Litem* and AAR Family Law, PLLC. Any postings to social media about the case shall be immediately removed and the parents authorize, Google, Avvo, Facebook, etc. to immediately remove the posts based upon this specific waiver. In the event a parent does

post things adverse to the Guardian *ad Litem* and/or AAR Family Law, PLLC, they shall immediately remove the listing and be responsible for all attorney's fees and costs associated with the enforcement of this contract and removal of the unauthorized review.

20. The Court shall reserve jurisdiction for the purposes of enforcement of this Order.

ORDERED in Tampa, Florida on _____

24-DR-001150 8/4/2026 4:58:07 PM


24-DR-001150 8/4/2026 4:58:07 PM
Judge Matthew Felix

The Honorable Matthew L. Felix
Circuit Judge

Copies to:
Sarah S. Hanson, Pro Se Petitioner
Christopher A. Hanson, Pro Se Respondent
Alexa A. Rodriguez, Guardian *ad Litem*